

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

## What's News

### Business & Finance

◆ **Trump's choice** to lead the Fed, Kevin Warsh, told senators he would chart a sharp departure from the central bank's recent approach while working to assure lawmakers he would maintain institutional independence from a president who has repeatedly voiced his preference for looser monetary policy. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks faltered** after a positive start and fell into the red at the close, with the S&P 500, Dow and Nasdaq all declining by 0.6%. **B11**

◆ **SpaceX said it secured** the right to buy artificial-intelligence coding startup Cursor for \$60 billion, an agreement that comes as SpaceX prepares for a massive public offering. **B1**

◆ **T-Mobile US and its** majority owner, Deutsche Telekom, are discussing combining to create a more streamlined telecom behemoth. **B1**

◆ **UnitedHealth reported** first-quarter results well in excess of Wall Street expectations and raised its annual guidance, signaling progress in rehabilitating its finances. **B1**

◆ **A UPS business unit** that handles package returns for retailers is adding another 1,700 drop-off locations. **B1**

◆ **United Airlines plans** to trim its capacity for the rest of the year as it contends with soaring fuel costs but would make adjustments up or down as demand required. **B2**

◆ **Defense contractor RTX** logged higher quarterly profit and sales as hostilities raise military budgets worldwide. **B3**

◆ **Northrop Grumman** recorded higher profit and sales for the first quarter, with sales of aeronautics systems jumping 17%. **B3**

### Worldwide

◆ **As negotiations with Iran** broke down before they had begun, Trump asked aides whether the U.S. should resume bombing, according to U.S. officials. Trump said on social media that he would extend the cease-fire. **A8**

◆ **Virginia voters** approved a measure to redraw the state's congressional map ahead of the midterms, giving a big boost to Democrats' efforts to reclaim control of the U.S. House. **A4**

◆ **Facing allegations** of financial impropriety, Rep. Sheila Cherfilus-McCormick resigned from the House, becoming the third lawmaker to quit in recent days rather than face a likely expulsion vote. **A4**

◆ **The Trump administration** secured an indictment against the Southern Poverty Law Center, alleging the civil-rights organization defrauded donors by secretly funneling money to extremist groups. **A4**

◆ **New York sued crypto** exchanges Coinbase and Gemini, accusing them of operating prediction markets that violate state gambling laws. **A2**

◆ **Florida launched a** criminal investigation into OpenAI over the role its chatbot played in a mass shooting that killed two people at Florida State University last year. **A3**

◆ **The Gates Foundation** will cut up to 500 jobs over the next several years, and opened an external review of its ties with Epstein. **A2**

◆ **Americans grew** more concerned about retirement security as they watch costs rise and fear for the health of entitlement programs. **A2**

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Senators questioned Fed nominee Kevin Warsh on Tuesday about his wealth and fealty to Trump.

# Warsh Pledges Independence At Fed Hearing

Central bank will maintain autonomy as Trump eyes rate cuts, nominee says

By Nick Timiraos

President Trump's pick to lead the Federal Reserve, Kevin Warsh, told senators Tuesday he would chart a sharp departure from the central bank's recent approach while promising to maintain institutional independence from a president who has repeatedly voiced his preference for looser monetary policy. "The president never asked me to predetermine, commit, fix, decide on any interest rate decision in any of our discussions, nor would I ever agree to do so," Warsh said at his

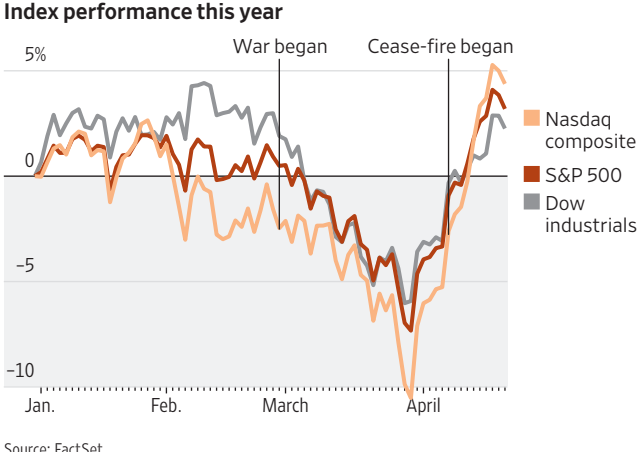
confirmation hearing on Capitol Hill. The hearing laid bare a political standoff that could delay his confirmation past the May 15 expiration of Jerome Powell's term as chair. Sen. Thom Tillis of North Carolina, a Republican on the Senate Banking Committee, repeated his refusal to advance Warsh, whom he praised, until the Justice Department drops its criminal investigation of Powell. Tillis and some other Republicans have called that probe a pretext to pressure Powell to resign or cut rates. After the hearing, Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R., S.D.) called on the administration to "wrap up this investigation" so Warsh could move forward. Trump showed no interest

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# Talks Stall, but Investors Can't Stop Buying

By Hannah Erin Lang and David Uberti

Days after the U.S. and Israel attack on Iran, Anthony Reid was at home in Dallas wondering whether a doomsday energy shock for the global economy was precisely the time to make a big bet. Reid stared at his phone and considered plowing a chunk of his savings into shares of Robinhood. He had reasons to hold off. First of all, it would be a lot of money for a 30-year-old Amazon delivery driver new to investing. Second, a historic oil disruption from a war in Iran could turbocharge inflation and hammer stocks. Reid, the father of two



boys, had also heard that the best time to invest was when others were scared off. "F— it," he recalled thinking, and clicked "buy." There are times when bad news is bad news for markets. There are times when bad

news is good news for markets. Then there are times like this—when bad news doesn't even register for investors, including Reid. From day traders to hedge funds, investors are once again running full-speed into stocks and loading up on risk. A skeptic could find plenty of cause for gloom: Oil tankers still can't freely traverse the Strait of Hormuz. The two sides were still trading threats when the next round of U.S.-Iran peace talks was put on pause. President Trump said Tuesday he would extend the cease-fire and blockade. Yet the three major U.S. stock indexes have marched back to prewar levels and then some. The tech industry's

## Negotiations In Limbo

Trump asks aides about resuming attacks on Iran after Vance trip is paused..... A8

Magnificent 7 gained \$2.5 trillion in market value over a recent eight-day stretch. Speculative bets are back. Allbirds, the onetime footwear favorite of techno optimists in the 2010s, gained almost 600% in one day last week after pivoting to—what else?—AI. Doubters warn that markets are increasingly driven by you-only-live-once bets and

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# After He Built a Giant, Cook Exits as Company Faces Biggest Hurdle: AI

By Rolfe Winkler

Steve Jobs will forever be credited with inventing the iPhone. Tim Cook used it to build an empire. Cook, who built Apple into a colossus with influence coursing through geopolitics, pop culture and the daily lives of billions of people, said he would step down as chief executive on Sept. 1. He will remain as executive chairman. He is stepping away from the top job as Apple's hero product surges to new sales re-

cords, its market capitalization exceeds \$4 trillion and its revenue is more than \$400 billion, quadruple what it was when he took over 15 years ago. Yet Cook, 65 years old, leaves the company in a potentially precarious position, trailing in artificial intelligence, which is revolutionizing the technology sector while Apple watches from the sidelines. No product this century has

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# Next Apple CEO Brings Expertise In Hardware, Collaborative Spirit

By Rolfe Winkler

The Mac Mini was sorely in need of an update, and John Ternus hoped he didn't need to go through design guru Jony Ive. Years ago, before Ternus was tapped to take the helm of one of the world's biggest and most influential companies, he led Apple's Mac hardware division. It was one of many stops as he rose through the ranks of the insular company and learned to navigate its curious internal politics. The AI revolution that would make the Mac Mini hugely pop-



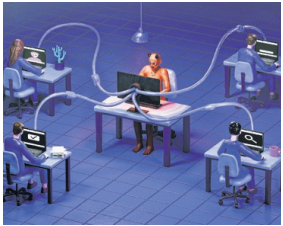
John Ternus, Apple's next CEO.

ular was still years away, yet software developers needed a new version with updated chips. A new enclosure for the

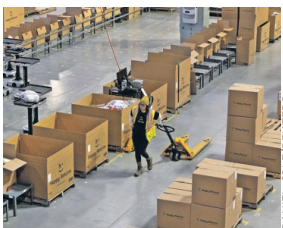
Mini could require work by Ive's industrial design department that could lead to delays. Ternus ordered the update after determining that the design wouldn't need a major change, people familiar with the move said. He didn't dwell on the product's profit potential, focusing instead on its value to Apple's overall ecosystem. It was one of many episodes that showed his decisiveness, keen understanding of Apple's culture and products, and how to get things done inside the company, the people said. Over his 25 year career at

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## INSIDE



**PERSONAL JOURNAL**  
Cybercriminals steal recruiters' identities to target job seekers. **A12**



**BUSINESS & FINANCE**  
For UPS, returning packages can be better business than delivering them. **B1**

## The New King of 'Jeopardy!' Is the Nicest Champ Ever

Even the show's nitpicky fans are smitten by the beautiful awkwardness of Jamie Ding

By John Jurgensen

With a streak of 27 wins and counting, Jamie Ding is a "Jeopardy!" assassin. He has blazing buzzer speed. A knowledge range that borders on omniscience. The nerve for wagers that make the studio audience gasp. Performance stats that have already earned him more than \$750,000 and a place among the show's all-time greats, including host Ken Jennings.



Cheery assassin

But his other superpower has nothing to do with gameplay. On a show that boasts television's nitpickiest fans, Ding has achieved the unthinkable: Everybody loves him. The 33-year-old wears his favorite color, orange, on ev-

ery episode. His game face is a study in microexpressions, from awkward smiles to eyebrow pops. His midround chats with Jennings have revealed a self-deprecating wit and interests so quirky they're cool—chasing eclipses, writing in italics, driving around with his trivia friends looking for a rare goose. During his intros, Ding offers a loopy little wave to the camera that looks like he's still getting the hang of it. It didn't take long before fans were returning the greeting. "Now I do it every time, too. I just smile at the TV and wave," says 28-year-old Lonny Starsky, who picked up the

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